

you via a TV news broadcast at the end of the game. The story was definitely one of the highlights for me but fans of the franchise might be a bit disappointed.

GAMEPLAY

Moving on to gameplay, this is a first person shooter game with third person cover based mechanics thrown into the mix. Don't expect this to be a running and gunning game. Sure, you can do that, but not to the same extent you would in games like Call of Duty or Battlefield. The game puts more emphasis on stealth while keeping the running and gunning approach as the secondary alternative.

Jensen has 'abilities' thanks to his augmentations which can be upgraded and unlocked as the game progresses. My only qualm with this is that you can only unlock a few augmentations in your first playthrough. I did a lot of the side quests alongside the main mission and still managed to unlock only about 35-40 percent of Adam's abilities. There is a 'new game plus' mode, but it would have been great if the casual player could unlock more in the first playthrough.

Speaking of these augmentations, they can broadly be categorized into stealth, running, gunning and hacking. If you are a stealthy player you will choose to unlock abilities like invisibility. For the runner and gunner, there are abilities which make you temporarily invulnerable (Crysis style) and for the hacker, the ability to hack into higher security terminals with ease. And this is barely the tip of the variety in augmentations. It's a treat to discover these abilities yourself and I assure you that executing some of them is very satisfying.

Where the game truly excels is with its level design. There are so many ways to tackle a mission, it's brilliant. Be it with something as simple as choosing certain dialogues or choosing a particular path, the number of options are overwhelming at times. There are times when there are 6-7 options to deal with a situation. Should I go guns blazing? Or



PROS

- Diverse gameplay
- Augmented abilities are great to experiment with
- Multiple endings
- Good visuals
- Good sound

CONS

- Character animation could have been better
- The way the ending is presented could have been different for different outcomes

■ **Developer:** Eidos Montreal, Nixxes Software BV

■ **Publisher:** Square Enix

■ **Platforms:** PlayStation 4, Xbox One, Microsoft Windows

■ **Tested on:** PlayStation 4

■ **Price:** PC: ₹999
PS4 and Xbox One: ₹3,499

sneak past? Or tell the cops about the situation so they can deal with it and I can just walk through? Should I bribe the officer blocking my path? Should I get fake papers made and succumb to the in-game corruption? It's mind boggling how much thought has gone into planning and executing each mission from different angles.

The gameplay and level design are the greatest strengths of this game.

GRAPHICS

Getting the worst out of the way, the character models aren't great. They

are bland and stiff and the lip sync is totally off. Adam Jensen is stiff during most of his conversations with NPC's, NPC's have emotionless expressions and are at times downright comical taking you out of the seriousness of the situation.

Having said that the overall game is gorgeous. The environments are well designed, action animation is fluid and overall the game is pretty. I did see the frame drop every now and then but this wasn't very evident during the high octane action sequences. It mostly happened when I was navigating from one part of the environment to another.

SOUND

Sound design is another place where the game excels but with some hiccups. For example, the high octane music kicked in when the action began and didn't die out like it was supposed to until the next cut scene began. I reloaded the game to see if this happens again and this time when the action ended so did the dramatic music. This happened a few times during my gameplay experience.

The voice acting in the game is good and believable, but like I said earlier, it's the character animations that make it less so.

SHOULD YOU BUY IT?

My friends that enjoy running and gunning games like Call of Duty and Gears of War weren't excited about the game, but my friends that enjoy stealth games like MGS5: TPP were immediately drawn to it. So if you are someone who likes sneaking around like Solid Snake then you should definitely check out Deus Ex. The game is worth multiple plays. But if you're a runner and gunner, you might want to stay away. The game is plagued with a few issues here and there, but none that hamper the overall experience. *

NOTE: The game does have micro transactions but I didn't encounter them. I played a review copy of the game and because of internet issues I couldn't download the updates of the game during the review process.